

Bradlaugh and Besant

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From 1882 to 1890, Charles Bradlaugh and Annie Besant ran a publishing company in London called the Freethought Publishing Company, based at 63 Fleet Street.

They republished a small book about birth control called *Fruits of Philosophy*. They wanted to help working people decide how many children to have. The book sold very well, but they were taken to court for sharing this information. Later, they won the case.

Bradlaugh became a Member of Parliament for Northampton. He also fought for the right to take his seat without making a religious promise, which helped lead to the Oaths Act 1888.

Besant became well known for helping the Match Girls Strike. She later moved to India and worked to give India its own government.

The company also published strong new ideas about women's rights, politics, and social change, and became an important place for new thinking in London.



*Charles Bradlaugh in 1877
at the time of the
Knowlton pamphlet trial*



*Annie Besant in 1877
at the time of the
Knowlton pamphlet trial*